



EVOLVED & BALANCED

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Supplements Complete Guide

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Science-Backed · Evidence-Based · No BS

Everything you need to know about sport supplements –
what works, what doesn't, and how to use them properly.

Data sourced from Examine.com · Peer-reviewed research



www.eb-athletic.com

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All information for educational purposes only.
Consult a healthcare professional before supplementing.

Introduction

Welcome to the Evolved & Balanced Complete Sports Supplements Guide. Whether you're a beginner stepping into the gym for the first time or an experienced athlete optimizing performance, this guide provides clarity in a world full of noise, hype, and misinformation.

The supplement industry generates billions annually, flooding the market with bold claims and confusing labels. Many people waste money on products they don't need, take them incorrectly, or buy low-quality formulations that deliver zero results.

What makes this guide different?

Every supplement in this guide is evaluated using data from Examine.com — the world's largest independent database of nutrition and supplement research, analyzing over 80,000 studies. We combine this evidence with practical, real-world application so you know exactly what works, what doesn't, and how to use it.

You'll also find goal-based stacks, common mistakes, and guidance on sourcing quality supplements in Egypt through trusted retailers like Super Supplement (super-eg.com) and iHerb (iherb.com).

Let's get into it.

How to use this guide

This guide is built to get you from “what should I take?” to a clear plan in minutes.

Step 1 - Check the basics

Read *Do you even need supplements?* Supplements only work on top of solid training, nutrition, and sleep.

Step 2 - Read the safety page

It’s short, and it matters.

Step 3 - Pick your goal

Go to *Goal-based stacks* and choose the one that matches you right now.

Step 4 - Learn what you’re taking

Tap any supplement in your stack to jump to its full breakdown: benefits, who should use it, dose, and best timing.

Step 5 - Buy smart

Use *How to choose quality supplements* before you spend a pound.

Tip: tap any title in the contents page to jump straight to that section.

Do you even need supplements?

Before spending a single pound, understand one fundamental truth: supplements are meant to supplement — not replace — a solid foundation of training, nutrition, sleep, and stress management.

The hierarchy of importance

1. Consistent Training — progressive overload, proper form, adequate volume
2. Nutrition — adequate protein (1.6-2.2g/kg), calories aligned with goals
3. Sleep & Recovery — 7-9 hours quality sleep, stress management
4. Consistency — months and years of adherence
5. Supplements — the final 5-10% optimization

When supplements make sense

Supplements become valuable when your foundation is solid and you want to close nutritional gaps, optimize recovery, or support specific goals. If you struggle to hit your daily protein target, whey protein is a practical solution. If you want to maximize strength, creatine monohydrate has decades of research behind it.

The bottom line

Think of supplements as tools — not magic pills. Used correctly and strategically, they provide a meaningful edge. Used without the right foundation, they're a waste of money.

Supplement Categories

Five main categories organized by primary purpose

Performance & Muscle Building

- 01 Whey Protein (Concentrate / Isolate / Hydrolyzed)
- 02 Casein Protein
- 03 Mass Gainers
- 04 Creatine Monohydrate
- 05 BCAAs & EAAs
- 06 Beta-Alanine
- 07 HMB
- 08 L-Arginine
- 09 Glutamine
- 10 Carbohydrate Supplements

Energy & Focus

- 01 Caffeine
- 02 Pre-Workout Formulas
- 03 L-Citrulline / Citrulline Malate
- 04 Taurine
- 05 Lion's mane
- 06 5-HTP
- 07 Electrolytes & Hydration
- 08 Ginkgo Biloba

Fat Loss

01	L-Carnitine
02	CLA (Conjugated Linoleic Acid)
03	Fat Burners / Thermogenics
04	Green Tea Extract (EGCG)
05	Yohimbine
06	Garcinia Cambogia
07	Water Pills / Diuretics
08	Chromium

Health & Recovery

01	Fish Oil / Omega-3s
02	Multivitamins
03	Vitamin D3
04	Vitamin C
05	B-complex
06	Vitamin B12
07	Vitamin K
08	Folic acid
09	Calcium
10	Magnesium
11	Zinc
12	Boron
13	Selenium
14	Copper
15	Biotin



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16	CoQ10
17	ALA (Alpha Lipoic Acid)
18	Collagen Peptides
19	Glucosamine & Chondroitin
20	MSM
21	Joint Support Complex
22	Ashwagandha
23	ZMA
24	Probiotics
25	Berberine
26	Spirulina
27	Turmeric / Curcumin
28	Milk Thistle
29	Digestive Enzymes
30	Ginger
31	Psyllium Husk
32	L-Lysine
33	Iron
34	Melatonin



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Testosterone & Hormonal Support

01	Full Testosterone Complexes
02	Tongkat Ali
03	D-Aspartic Acid
04	Maca
05	Panax Ginseng
06	Shilajit

Creatine Monohydrate

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A naturally occurring compound in muscle cells that helps produce ATP. Creatine monohydrate is the most studied form with ~99% bioavailability at standard doses (5-10g). A systematic review of 17 clinical trials comparing 7 formulations confirmed monohydrate remains the lowest-cost and best-studied form.

BENEFITS

- + Meta-analysis of 69 RCTs (1,937 participants): increased power output and strength
- + Meta-analysis of RCTs: improved memory, attention, and processing speed in adults
- + Enhances muscle cell volumization via intracellular water retention
- + ISSN position stand: safe up to 30g/day for 5 years with no detrimental effects
- + Most cost-effective supplement available

WHO SHOULD USE IT

Anyone doing resistance training or high-intensity sports. Beneficial for beginners and advanced athletes. Increasingly recommended for cognitive health and aging populations.

DOSAGE

Loading phase of ~0.3g/kg/day for 5-7 days, then maintenance of 3-5g/day. Or simply 3-5g daily (saturates stores in 3-4 weeks without loading).

BEST TIMING

Timing is flexible. Creatine works through daily saturation, not acute dosing. Can be taken any time with water or a meal.

SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE

The single most researched sports supplement in history (500+ peer-reviewed studies). ISSN confirms it is safe, effective, and the most beneficial supplement for high-intensity exercise. Buffered creatine (Kre-Alkalyn) showed no advantages over monohydrate in a 36-person RCT. Creatine ethyl ester was found less effective.

TOP PICKS

Available at Super Supplement & iHerb



USN Pure Creatine



MuscleTech Platinum Creatine



Rule One Creatine



Bpi Sports Micronized Creatine

Garcinia Cambogia (HCA)

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A tropical fruit containing hydroxycitric acid (HCA), marketed as a fat loss miracle after media attention. HCA theoretically inhibits citrate lyase (an enzyme involved in fat production) and may increase serotonin to suppress appetite. Despite massive consumer popularity, the evidence for meaningful fat loss in humans is very weak.

BENEFITS

- + Theoretically inhibits citrate lyase enzyme (fat production pathway)
- + May modestly suppress appetite via serotonin mechanisms
- + Some studies show very small reductions in body weight (~0.9kg more than placebo)

WHO SHOULD USE IT

Not strongly recommended for anyone based on current evidence. The fat loss effects are negligible in practice. Those looking for marginal appetite support during a caloric deficit may try it, but expectations should be very low.

DOSAGE

Typical dose in studies: 500-1500mg HCA per day, split into 2-3 doses. Taken 30-60 minutes before meals.

BEST TIMING

30-60 minutes before meals for appetite suppression effect.

SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE

A 2011 meta-analysis found a statistically significant but clinically insignificant difference in weight loss (~0.9kg). Many studies are short-term, small, and methodologically weak. The famous Dr. Oz endorsement was not based on strong science, and a 2016 FTC settlement confirmed the marketing claims were deceptive.

TOP PICKS

Available at Super Supplement & iHerb



NOW Foods Garcinia Extract



Swanson Garcinia Cambogia



NatureWise Garcinia Cambogia



Sports Research Garcinia Cambogia